



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 10 ISSUE
Jan 2023

#1

COMING EVENTS

FEBRUARY

- 2nd Monthly Meeting
- 5th Presentation Lunch
- 7th OASIS Run Mooney Mooney
- 8th Committee Meeting

MARCH

- 2nd Monthly Meeting
- 4th Central Coast W'shop
- 8th Committee Meeting
- 11th Sydney Workshop
- 18h Fish & Chip Run

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Was it an Annual General Meeting mixed with the AHOC Christmas Party, or was it the AHOC Christmas Party mixed with an Annual General Meeting?

Whatever way you viewed the evening, it was a very successful with everyone looking to be enjoying themselves. Many thanks to Christine Lyttle for making the arrangements, and ensuring that each of the tables that apart from the freshly starched table-cloths and polish cutlery, was suitable festively decorated along with a special table set aside holding what seemed to be a collection of gifts. Actually they were the lucky door prizes.

While our AGM is normally held in November, it was decided to postpone it to Thursday 1st December and squeeze it in prior to the commencement of festivities. And a good idea it was and thanks to Gordon Lynas the formalities were over and done with in

around ten minutes and no one was worse for wear. Thanks also to Gordon for his MCing throughout the evening.

Everyone had arrived in plenty of time to enjoy a good natter while enjoying a glass or two of wine. Dinner in the form of a plentiful two courses was served and from comments was certainly enjoyed by everyone. Wine was available throughout the evening followed by coffee and tea.

Thanks to Jim Phillips there was an overhead screen operating throughout the evening showing scenes from throughout the year. Later in the evening, founding and life member Joe Armour was up-standing to provide an enjoyable critique on a number of long-term members which certainly kept everyone amused.

A most enjoyable evening.

Cont' page 13



POST: AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au
WEB: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au
FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Well! Christmas is over for another year and most of the decorations have been stored for a further 12 months. The New Year is upon us and I'm assuming that for most of us, midnight on 31 December found us punching out zzzs, rather than popping corks.

Planning for 2023 events for our club is underway and you will find details in this issue as well as on our website.

Probably the big one for our club is hosting the National Rally in the Hunter. The rally committee under the leadership of Gordon Lynas is putting the final touches to the program. Numbers are growing and if you have been thinking about joining for what should be a fabulous time with Austin-Healey owners from across Australia and haven't booked yet, it is definitely time you did.

The other event that needs men-



tioning is the presentation lunch where we start the year by acknowledging those members that were successful in various club activities during 2022.

This year it will be held on Sunday 5th February. One of the trophies to be awarded is the Alan Jones Trophy and we need your input to nominate a club member that you consider worthy of this prestigious award. Alan Jones is a name that the longer serving members of our club know well, but not the more recent ones. I never knew him, but I've only been a member for just over 25 years. Alan was a founding mem-

ber and was extremely active in promoting Healeys and Austin-Healey in NSW, Australia and throughout the world, in fact there is a national trophy presented in his honour at the National Rally. Alan was involved in organising events of all types and actively engaged in Motorsport with a 3000 Mk1 and 100S. One of his characteristics was that he was always ready to lend a helping hand and was doing just that when he died in 1979 as a result of a motor vehicle accident. This is a trophy, where the recipient is decided by a vote of the members. So we

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COMMITTEE LIST - 2022

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Jim Phillips
8 Belina Ave.,
Wyoming NSW 2250
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Vice-President - Geoff Smith
0458 777 339
m.gpsmith@bigpond.com

Secretary - Julie Lee
0421 598 755
hedli@tpg.com.au

Treasurer - Jenny Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Social Secretary - Bruce Ewan
bruce.ewan1@gmail.com
Assisted by Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
deniskasza@gmail.com

Editor - Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Rd.,
Kurrajong Heights 2758
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_cquinn@tpg.com.au

Historian - Joe Armour
0419 233 099
joea6@bigpond.com

Membership Secretary - Christine Lyttle
0410 201 373
membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Regalia - Colin Rule
0467 563 523
coolibahconvertible@bigpond.com

Technical Officer - Greg Strange
02 9319 2299
gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_quinn@tpg.com.au

They're changing guard at
Buckingham Palace.
"An editor's life is terrible hard,"
says Alice.

Apologies Mr Milne

Greetings and welcome to January
2023 and the first issue of the Flat
Chat Newsletter for the New Year.
Best wishes from Caroline and
myself for the New Year.

The start of a new year also means
a new AHOC Committee, the
details of which you will find at
the bottom of page 2 of this issue
of Flat Chat. While the names
might look familiar there are a
couple of new ones tucked away
in there. Welcome back to Geoff
Smith as vice president after
being absent for 12 months, but
it's a very big welcome to Jenny
Penman who has taken on the
role of treasurer. I am sure I'm
speaking for everyone when to
send our appreciation to Jenny
for taking on the role. Another
name is Denis Kasza who put up
his hand to assist social secretary

Bruce Ewan. It's a big welcome to
Denis.

While the names are familiar or
new, a fresh committee always
means a renewed enthusiasm with
members looking forward to what
a new club year will bring. I am
certainly looking forward to it, as
I hope you all are as well.

So what's in the first issue of
Flat Chat for 2023? With the
Christmas Party still fresh in our
memories there is a report on the
enjoyable event starting on page
1. Thanks to Colin Rule we have
some words and photos on the
final Central Coast Chapter for
2022. In addition appreciation to
Kerry McDonald of the ACT for
sending along words and photos
on the Terrible British Day held
at Queanbeyan on December 4th.
Of course there are the expected
committee reports including the
AGM minutes – you won't want
to miss them.

There is also a synopsis of events

reported on during 2022 plus a
lengthy and soporific article by a
club member concerning his first
five years.

Not much has advanced on the
Quinn Austin-Healey. A week
before Christmas the spare engine
block was taken to Redi-strip
at Blacktown for a final clean.
While much time has been spent
digging out the accumulated
sludge, a thorough chemical clean
was thought necessary. On the
subject of taking things away, I
have a large collection of classic
car magazines from the 1980s
through for over 20 years. I am
about to send them for recycling,
but should anyone wish to have
them just let me know.

Trust you enjoy this issue of
the Flat Chat Newsletter. I look
forward to receiving plenty of
contributions from members as
after all there would be no point in
publishing Flat Chat each month
without them.



Have I said that I've
done this before?

Monthly Meetings

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month (not January) at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**



Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc Annual General Meeting

Minutes of the meeting held 1 December 2022 at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Road, Strathfield NSW 2135

Present – refer Club Point Score List for attendees

Gordon Lynas, President and Chair of the meeting, noting that there was a quorum, called the meeting to order at 7:00 pm, and welcomed all attendees.

The Chair advised that no proxies had been received for the meeting. Apologies advised prior to and at the meeting were received.

1. 2021 Annual General Meeting Minutes

Draft minutes of the 2021 AGM had been published in the December 2021 edition of Flat Chat, plus they had been included in the AGM Notice which had been sent to members on 12 November 2022.

RESOLVED that draft minutes of the Annual General Meeting held 4 November 2021 be approved.

2. Committee Report

The Committee's report had been included in the AGM Notice.

RESOLVED that the Committee's Report for 2021/22 be noted.

3. Financial Statements

The Club's financial statements had been included in the AGM Notice.

RESOLVED that the financial statements for the year ending 30 June 2022 be approved.

4. Election of Committee Members

The Chair conducted the election of Committee members. Completed nominations had been received by the due date for the following roles, so each was duly elected by Members at the meeting:

- President – Jim Phillips
- Vice President – Geoff Smith
- Secretary – Julie Lee
- Treasurer – Jenny Penman
- Membership Secretary – Christine Lyttle
- Club Registrar – Patrick Quinn
- Editor – Patrick Quinn
- Public Officer – Alan Mitchell
- Regalia Officer – Colin Rule
- Webmaster – Jim Phillips
- Historian – Joe Armour
- Public Relations Officer – Ross Penman
- Technical Officer – Greg Strange

A nomination was taken from the floor for the following role, which was duly elected by Members at the meeting:

- Webmaster – Jim Phillips

No nominations were received for the role of Social Secretary.

5. Invitation to Honorary Membership

The Chair referred to the constitutional requirement for honorary members to be approved by members each year.

RESOLVED that invitations to honorary membership be extended to Bob Cutler and Graham Healey.

There being no further business, the Chair closed the meeting at 7:15pm and everyone got stuck into dinner.



Membership Report

Christine Lyttle 0410 201 373

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Welcome to the New Year, hope that you all enjoyed a very Merry Christmas and ready for another year.

We have one new member this month – Mark Sullivan from Concord as an associate member with the possibility of purchasing an Austin-Healey in the future. The membership form has arrived for John Kirk and John has been added to the website together with all his details. Still awaiting membership forms from Chris Jenkins and Kim Gillis.

The Christmas Party was a great social event which was enjoyed by all who attended. This year we combined it with a very short Annual General Meeting which was over and done with efficiently and did not consume too much time out of the party atmosphere.

I thank you to the committee for 2022, it was great working with you and look forward to working with the committee in 2023 with some new faces holding positions, Jim back as the president and Jenny Penman as treasurer. Also wonderful to welcome De-

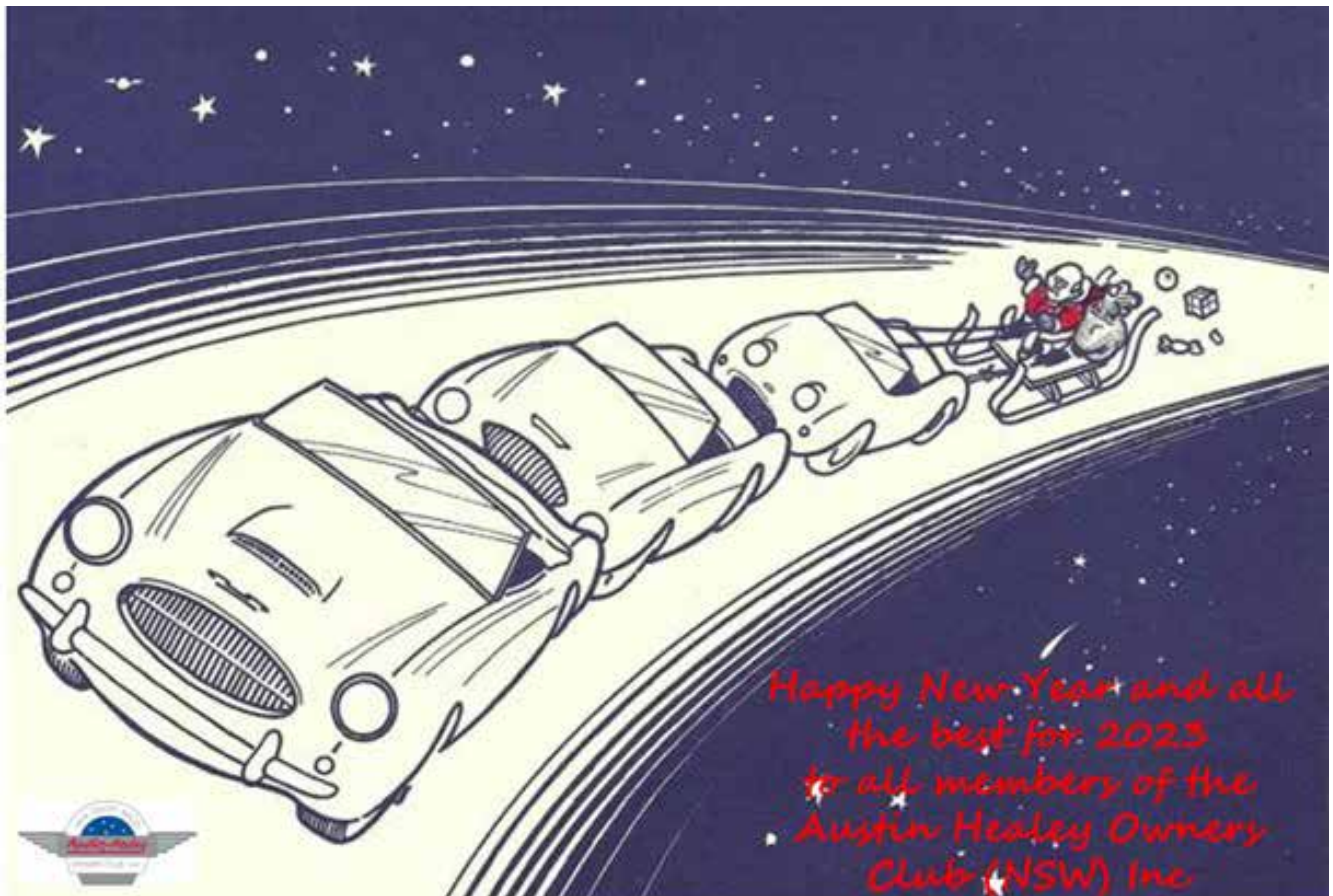
nis Kasza who is assisting Bruce Ewan with social events – look forward to some great social events during 2023.

The Club has recently acquired credit card facility which will incur a small surcharge of up to 2.2% of the cost of your membership, regalia item or rally ticket. Should you wish to use this service either at a club meeting, event, over the phone or entered on your membership form in the future we can certainly assist. We have two devices, one with the membership secretary and the other by the regalia officer – Colin Rule.

Don't forget to let me know if you change your postal address, email or any other details so we can keep your details as correct as possible, send any changes to membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au. Why not log in and check the website changes.

Keep safe and well during the holiday season! Hope to see you at the Awards Day Lunch!

Happy Healeying
Christine Lyttle





Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493
Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com
 Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
deniskasza@gmail.com

Happy New Year. With New Year's Eve festivities behind us, it's time to reveal the plans to make 2023 one of the best ever.

A large and diverse list of events and activities have been planned that should appeal. What will make 2023 the best year ever, is your involvement in the social activities. The more members that participate the better enjoyment of each who are there and the more diverse and interesting the discussions will be.

We are really pleased to welcome the wonderful assistance of Denis Kasza. Denis has stepped forward to assist in the creation and organising of events, which have grown in volume. Denis has put forward many great ideas and suggestions. The flyers created for the presentation day lunch created by Denis are evidence of his technical expertise and design prowess.

Technical workshops for the Central Coast continue to attract members and will be held on the first Saturday of each month with the exception of January, February, July and December.

Sydney Technical Workshops will be held second Saturday of each month, with the exception of January, February, July and December.

Dates to Note:

5 February – Awards Day Lunch hosted by Julie & Garry Lee Niagara Park – see below
 7 February – Oasis Run Mooney Mooney
 4 March – Central Coast Technical Workshop
 11 March – Sydney Technical Workshop
 18 March – Paradise Café Hawkesbury - Saturday Night Fish & Chips Run
 1 April – Central Coast Technical Workshop
 23 April – Thirlmere Railway Museum
 2-5 May – National Rally
 13 May – Sydney Technical Workshop
 3 June – Central Coast Technical Workshop
 10 June – Sydney Technical Workshop
 24-25 June - Rose Café Goulburn

2 July – Donald Healey Birthday and Display Day
 5 August – Central Coast Technical Workshop
 12 August – Cherry Blossom Auburn Botanic Gardens
 26 August – Continental Run - Centennial Park to La Perouse
 2 Sep – Central Coast Technical Workshop
 4-8 Sep – Painted Silo's Run - Western Districts
 Sep - All British Day - Dates TBA
 7 Oct – Central Coast Technical Workshop
 14 Oct – Sydney Technical Workshop
 Oct – Charlie's Run
 4 Nov – Central Coast Technical Workshop
 11 Nov – Sydney Technical Workshop
 Dec – Christmas Party
 Dec – Terribly British Day - Queanbeyan (Dates TBA)

Greater detail will be added to the events section of the AHOC NSW website, including times and location.

There are many more ideas and details to be added over coming weeks.

If you have ideas or a suggestion please contact us at the above.

Of course, the first big get together of the year is the Awards Day Lunch to be held 5 February, 2023. This is a fully catered event subsidised by the AHOC. Generously hosted by Philip Bloom for many years, 2023 will see a change in venue to Julie and Garry Lee's new home at Niagara Park on the Central Coast.

Event: Awards Day Lunch

Date: Sunday 5 February 2023

Times: 11:00am – 3:00pm

Address: 20 Siletta Rd, Niagara Park

For members coming from the south we are meeting at the old Berowra Toll Gates at 9:30am (Departing 10:00am)

Cost: This event is subsidised by the AHOC. There is a small charge per head to be advised after the next committee meeting.

Register: PLEASE register in advance so that we can cater accordingly or via the above.

FEB
5



AWARDS DAY LUNCH 11-3PM

**JULIE AND GARRY LEE'S
20 SILETTA ROAD
NIAGARA PARK**
Southern members, meet
Old Berowra Toll Gates
9.30 dep 10am. Details
Denis Kasza 0407492008



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

ZZZZ! It's a quiet time for renewals of Conditional Registration. Apart from new registrations, I usually only hear from members on the annual anniversary of when their vehicle was first registered and I suspect that most members didn't do this around the Christmas/New Year period.

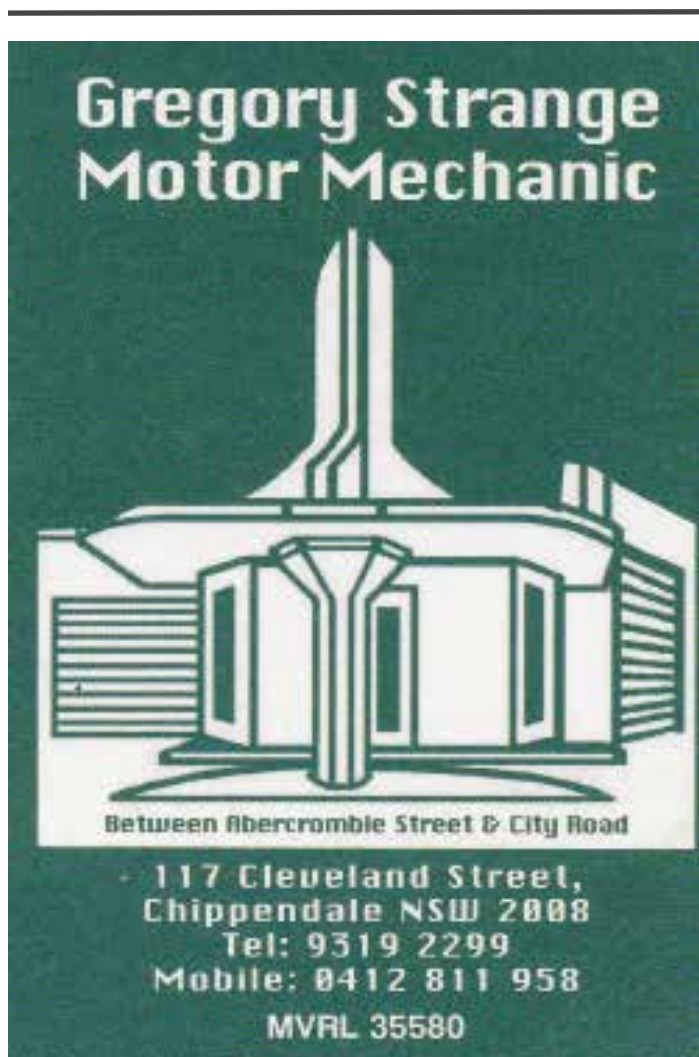
We finished 2022 with 220 vehicles conditional registered through the AHOC and of these there were 74 marque vehicles, ie Healey, Austin-Healey or Jensen-Healey. The remaining 147 vehicles fall within the model age from 1904 through to 1992.

If you are interested, by far the second favourite marques are Jaguar and Ford with 13 examples each, followed by eight MGs, eight Porsches, five Land Rovers, four Range Rovers and so on.

Remember that all conditionally registered vehicles still need to undergo an annual roadworthy inspection. Luckily we have two inspecting officers who will do that for you at absolutely no cost. These are Neville Stirton and Geoff Smith. You will find their contact details on page 2 of every Flat Chat. In case you didn't know, not all clubs have an internal inspection service and they insist on Pink Slips, that will cost. So thanks again to Neville and Geoff for putting up their hands to assist their fellow members.

"What do I do to renew my registration?" Remains the most frequently asked question I hear. So once again below are the steps that need to occur.

- Once you have received the renewal from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this *Flat Chat Newsletter* for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this *Flat Chat Newsletter* for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

Central Coast Gathering - 3rd December

We were at the end of 2022 and Christmas was with us once again! Our final workshop for the year was held on 3 December where we all met up with our Sydney folk at Somersby, and then drove in convoy to the beautiful Yarramalong Valley for lunch.

A gorgeous summer morning with still a hint of spring in the air. We called in to have a look at the completely full Mangrove Creek dam, but unfortunately the public facilities were closed for renovations.

So we continued on enjoying our morning drive through to the Yarramalong Valley where we had a superb lunch at the Angel Sussurri Cafe. What a great spot! We will re-visit this cafe again, that's for sure.

There were 14 in attendance. A very warm welcome to first timers Ray and Muriel Roberts and Bob and Angela Ratcliff with their BJ8. Denis Kasza Westminster, Julie and Garry Lee BJ8, John Kirk Sprite Mk2, Jenni and Ian Richter as well as Roger Ramsey and sister Rosemary who was on holidays from England.

The next Central Coast workshop will held on the 4th of February 2023 at South Kincumber, all going well.

Happy Healeying Folks and all the very best for 2023.

Col and Kerrie Rule.



Healey Christmas Card



How was your Christmas card haul?

Images of a large bearded bloke dressed in red, defying gravity with a bunch of reindeer and a cart without wheels; scenes of frozen snow on European trees when outside your window people are heading for the beach; or the red cheeks of cherubic children eager to rip apart the carefully packaged presents.

Always lovely to receive Christmas cards and to know that someone is thinking of you when your credit card is maxed out and the fridge is bulging with food that will all end up around your waistline.

So, I was pleased to receive this card that reminds me of the Donald Healey Motor Company's foray at Le Mans from 1968 to 1970. I won't say who it was from, but I'm sure many would be able to guess.

Most would know that the Healey SR ran at Le Mans in closed form in 1968 and '69. It was then lengthened and had its top removed for 1970 when it ran in open form as the Healey XR37.

The Healey XR37 has been in Sydney since the early 1970s.

President's Message cont'

need you to please consider which one of our club members should receive this award and email your suggestion enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au with not only the name, but the reason for your nomination. Alternatively write it down and bring it along to the general meeting on the 2nd February.

The other award(?) for members to determine is the Hard luck Trophy and that will be decided at the presentation lunch when stories will be told and the loser decided.

Finally, I'm looking forward to working with my fellow committee members in 2023, I want to thank

Gordon and John for their service and dedication to the club through their involvement in the committee over the past years and welcome Jenny Penman, Geoff Smith and Denis Kasza on board for 2023. I also want to thank those club members that have been in touch with me with suggestions for our club meetings and social activities, as it is extremely encouraging to know that members are engaged with what the club does which. In my opinion makes it a great club.

May you have good health, lots of happiness, and a great New Year.

Jim Phillips





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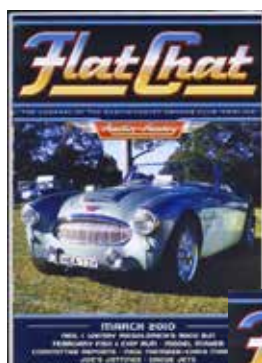
healeyfactory.com.au

646 Whitehorse Road, Mitcham VIC 3132 (03) 9872 3900

Flat Chat Back Issues

Interested in receiving backcopies of Flat Chat?
Now available, digital copies of Flat Chat for 2005
through to January 2023.

That's 190+ issues for you to read at your leisure.
Free and gratis to members. All you have to do is send
a 1-3GB USB (thumb) drive to me at the below address
along with a stamped self-address envelope.



Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



Painted Silos Run by Terry Bancroft

I have proposed a trip around New South Wales during this year visiting the painted silos in a number of towns, namely Weethalle, Barraba, Dunedoo, Grenfell, Gunnedah, Merriwa, Murrumburrah Mills and Portland.

I have seen these promoted on the ABC's Landline each Sunday and think they look great. They also put dollars into small communities

Our new president Jim Phillips has given me verbal approval to put it together and I feel early spring may be a good time, with better dates decided as we put it together.

I would like members who are interested to register their interest so I know how many would like to go and I could organise Motels etc, maybe lunches on the way etc etc. I don't wish to have to handle money so it will be you pay as you go.

There are also painted water towers, but many of these are one day trips so we might put a couple of them on a weekend to whet the appetite.

I feel photographic enthusiasts freaks will excel on the trip.

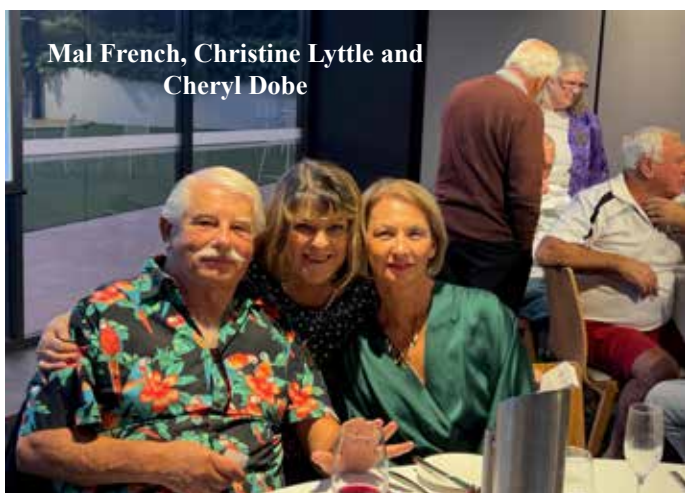
Call either Denis Kasza on 0407 492 008 or Terry Bancroft 0409 323 133 or email bangers@bancroft.id.au



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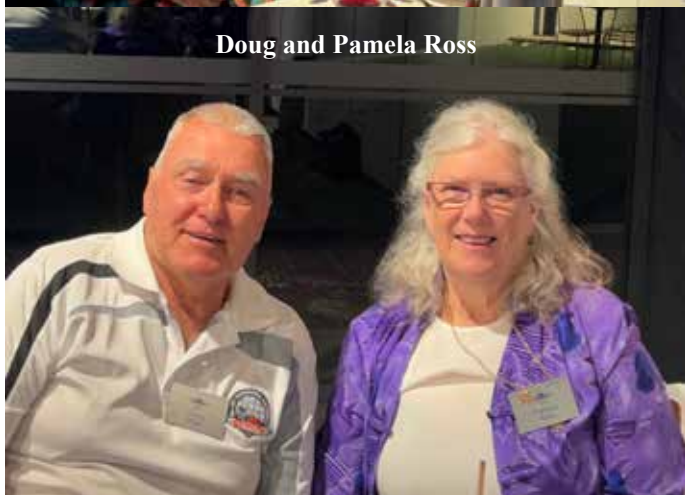
Lucky Door Prizes



Mal French, Christine Lyttle and
Cheryl Dobe



Jo Hutton and Allan
Whitehouse



Doug and Pamela Ross



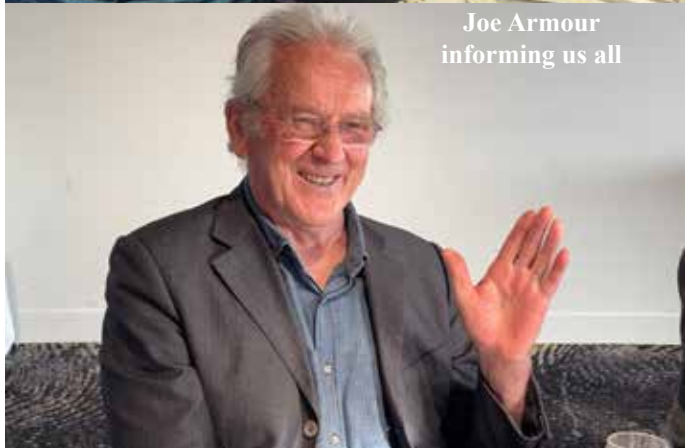
Gordon Lynas (standing) with
Bruce Reynolds, Philip Bloom
and Lehman Bloom



Garry and Julie Lee



Russell and Carol Kelly



Joe Armour
informing us all

The Matchbox "Highway" Pack that Never Was



Thank you to Alan Michell for sending in this photo of five Austin-Healey scale models produced by Matchbox.

Alan says that while the five models came from Matchbox, they were never sold together in a single package. What to do?

Simple! Make one. That's what he did, and the five Austin-Healey models are in the order of release with the latest on the bottom.

It's not known if Alan is taking orders.

Six-Volt Quest

Recently heard from South-Coast member Bevan Cursley about his search for two six-volt batteries for his BN6.

Remembering that not long back Colin Rule had purchased two for his BN2, I sent Bevan in Colin's direction.

After a week or so Bevan came back saying that while six-volt batteries are readily available around the Central Coast area, not so in Bermagui on the South Coast. While some sources were found on-line, none would ship. Additionally, the prices being asked by various supplies varied wildly.

So Bevan is now on a quest for two Century six-volt lead acid batteries that are identified as 03- 270CCA 65 amps. Would any AHOC member be aware of alternative battery manufacturers that supply batteries with the same specifications as Century, and perhaps an idea of a reasonable price to pay?

Bevan may be contacted on 0498 750 909.



The February meeting is scheduled for 7.30pm Thursday the 2nd at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Come along from 5.30pm and enjoy dinner in the bistro with your fellow club members.

Terribly British Daya superb day out!

by Kerry McDonald



Terribly British Day was again celebrated at Queanbeyan Park on 4th December 2022. Initial setup saw an early cloud covered morning that soon turned out to be a beautiful day.

For those who have not attended in the past, this park is located close to the Queanbeyan CBD but you could be half a world away in a English village, so special is this park. It has been awarded an international Green Flag Award, indicating its high

standards to display, the cars benefitting from the shade of the tree lined surrounds. Our Austin-Healey banner marked our presence this year. The Austin-Healey models represented included three Sprites (MKIs of Colin Smeal and John Furlan, and Michael Moore's MKIIIA), the BN1 of Wayne and Sandra Smith, two BN4s (Trevor and Keren Clement, and Kerry McDonald), the BT7 Mk1 of Tim Lewis and Margaret Lyons, and the two BJ8s of Terry Pulford and Greg and Kerri Poole in their Old English White over Lobelia Blue BJ8. It was great to meet up with Greg and Kerri in particular, as they had driven all the way from Bathurst to participate. Possibly next year we will see some more of the Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW) members joining the local ACT and surrounds Austin-Healey owners at this display.



A highlight for all of the participating British car and motorcycle clubs this year was the opportunity to drive around the sloped endurance track at slow speed so that everyone could gain the best view. In attendance to voice the proceedings was 'Lord Joseph', the ACT and Queanbeyan Town Crier, a car enthusiast himself as the owner of a MGB.



standard as a recreational park. The park is surrounded by an outstanding range of established trees, some dating back to the 1870s when first established. Central to the park is the Brad Haddin Oval, where cricket is played over summer. Around the oval is a banked terrace which was once a velodrome, but now an endurance track for runners. There are plenty of amenities available, with BBQs, a children's playground and tennis courts adjacent.

Amongst a broad range of British marques, nine Austin-Healey owners brought their special ma-



AHOC member Greg Poole with his BJ8.

Terribly British

While circulating in the crowds, it was great (but sad) to farewell Stanley and Michelle Van Wijk as they are moving to Sussex, UK, taking their immaculate red BJ8 with them. Stanley indicated that he wishes to keep in contact with us and we will hope to hear news in the not too distant future of his engagement with an Austin-Healey club in the UK.

Overall, it was a great day and we thank the Triumph Club of the ACT for organising this successful car club event.



Under the bonnet of Terry Pulford's BJ8.

Sold in the UK for £44,500

For what seemed to be not much money, this 1953 Healey Abbott was sold just prior to Christmas for £44,500 or Au\$79,500.

It was sold through an online auction by Car and Classic. Have a look at <https://www.carandclassic.com/auctions/1953-healey-abbott-24-litre-n90j3g> for more information and photos.





Unforgettable memories...



**Tuesday 2 May –
Friday 5 May 2023**



Chateau Elan

in the heart of the
famed Hunter Valley

Vintage Drive, Pokolbin NSW 2320

Nestled among rolling vineyards and
overlooking manicured fairways, breathtaking
scenery for its comprehensive offering, the
resort offers luxury hotel style accommodation

A Luxurious Holiday Experience in the Hunter Valley

16 Spa Treatment Rooms, Pool, Gym, Golf Course

Bookings direct to the Resort in advance



Bookings for the Resort must be made on the Chateau Elan's booking form
and sent with the payment direct to the Resort

Note Resort costs are not included in the ticket price of ~~\$500~~ \$440



Unforgettable memories..



RALLY NEWS

October 2022

Six months to go and many of you have now made your bookings for **HEALEYS IN THE HUNTER**. If you haven't yet booked your tickets and room, don't delay as they are filling up fast. We are well on our way to filling the 100 rooms at the beautiful Chateau Elan.

It's going to be a great Rally and just to whet your appetite, here is our [program of events](#).

Tuesday 2 May

Check in to [Chateau Elan](#) from 3pm and pick up your welcome pack at reception. At 7pm join everyone on the [Fairway Lawn](#) for Canapes and drinks.

Wednesday 3 May

Up early for a final polish, then drive your vehicle to the [Austin-Healey display](#) to view the other cars ([10am to 12 noon](#)). Enjoy [Hunter Valley Gardens](#) or browse the shops at [Pokolbin Village](#), taste some wine or vodka, or pick up a memento or two, or just stop for coffee and cake.

From 3pm to 5pm come and taste some [Hunter Valley wines and cheeses](#).



This evening is [Party Night!](#) Your 2 course dinner begins at 7pm in the [Founders Room](#), followed by as much dancing as anyone could want, or just enjoy chatting to friends old and new.

Thursday 4 May

This morning enjoy an organised country drive to either the historic [Hunter port town of Morpeth](#) or to picturesque [Wollombi](#). Or just enjoy some of the many delights of the Hunter Valley: [Maitland Art Gallery](#) is well worth a visit and has a great coffee shop; be wowed by the gorgeous views from the [Audrey Wilkinson winery's](#) hilltop location; or from the [Mt Bright lookout](#); or maybe book a [Go-Kart](#) session at nearby Kearsley and then test your putting prowess on the adjacent [Mount Panorama mini-golf](#). These and more are available for your enjoyment!

This evening is the [Gala Dinner](#). Once again we will congregate in the [Founders Room](#) for dinner to wrap up this Rally and to learn about the 2024's Rally.

Thursday is your opportunity for a round of Golf at the Vines or to be pampered at the Spa (early bookings essential for both).

Friday 5 May

Sadly, this morning it is time to pack our bags and say goodbye until next year. Join everyone for a [Farewell Brunch](#) in the restaurant (\$39 per person if you haven't included breakfasts with your room booking).

Why not book in a day early and enjoy the special accommodation rate being offered and enjoy the exclusive [Chateau Elan](#) and book a spa treatment or a round of golf?

Should you have any questions about the rally please do not hesitate to contact the committee via the designated email for the rally rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com and one of the rally committee will reply depending on your query.

That's it until 2023!

Your Rally Committee



THE AUSTIN-HEALEY 2023 NATIONAL RALLY

TUESDAY 2 MAY – FRIDAY 5 MAY 2023

REGISTRATION FORM

**REGISTRATIONS CLOSE ON
TUESDAY 31 JANUARY 2023**

unless numbers are at capacity and then you will be shortlisted

Rally Registrar:

Christine Lyttle

Email: rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com

Mail: PO Box 2754,

North Parramatta NSW 1750

Mobile: 0410 201 373

ADULTS ATTENDING

1.	2.
----	----

Regrettably no children to attend this event

YOUR PERSONAL DETAILS

Postal Address:

Suburb:	State:	Postcode:
---------	--------	-----------

Club:	Mobile:
-------	---------

Email:

Special Dietary Requirements (please tick box in front or make comment):

☐ Diabetes ☐ Coeliac ☐ Gluten Free ☐ Vegetarian Other _____

CAR DETAILS

REGISTRATION NUMBER

☐ 100	☐ 100S	☐ 100/6	☐ 3000 MKI
☐ 3000 MKII	☐ 3000 MKIII	☐ SPRITE	☐ MODIFIED

OTHER



THE AUSTIN-HEALEY 2023 NATIONAL RALLY

TUESDAY 2 MAY – FRIDAY 5 MAY 2023

REGISTRATION FORM

Page 2

National Rally Ticket Price Includes:

- ❖ Welcome party including food and drinks
- ❖ Party Night including dinner and drinks
- ❖ Gala Dinner including dinner, drinks and entertainment
- ❖ Car display show and shine event
- ❖ And more....

Please complete below		\$440		
Number of Adults		@ \$500	Total	\$
Booking of Interest completed	Date:		Amount Paid	\$
			Sub Total	\$
Ticket Price is in Australian Dollars			Total Due	\$

The Ticket Price has been reduced by \$60 to cover the breakfast @ \$20 per person per day due to the Resort accommodation system

The registration form is also available on our website: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au

PAYMENT OF RALLY TICKETS – receipt will be issued for all monies received	
DIRECT DEPOSIT - EFT	Account Name: Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Incorporated Westpac Banking Corporation BSB: 032 669 Account Number: 252564 Date amount deposited: ____ / ____ / ____ Please enter your SURNAME RALLY 2023 in reference field to reconcile
CHEQUE / MONEY ORDER	Made payable to Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Incorporated Mail to address on Page 1 to the Registrar
Registrations will not be finalised until full payment is received	

*Rally ticket refunds available until 30 days prior to the start of the event.
Full cancellation fee applies after this due to commitments to the Resort and other venues, the organising committee cannot guarantee a refund.
A reminder – if cancelling do not forget to contact the Resort to cancel your room and check their refund rules*

REGISTRAR USE DATE RECEIVED ____ / ____ / ____ RECEIPT SENT ____ / ____ / ____ REGISTRATION NO ____

Comments _____

For Sale & Wanted

For Sale

1955 Austin-Healey 100 BN2 (BN2/228918). Delivered new to Melbourne, Australia.
Build date 22 October 1955.

This BN2 has been lovingly restored to high standard by my partner, who is now deceased and I cannot drive the car. It goes well and is conditionally registered (not transferrable) with 199 miles on the clock since restoration. Has always been garaged and looked after. Price. \$ 95,000 or near offer. Please contact Ellen Goodwin 0405 385 473.



Wanted

A 100/6 or 3000 rear engine plate. Perhaps you have one propping up the door to your garage.

If you have one spare, and would like to see it being put to good use please give Neville Stirton a call on 0414 472 877.



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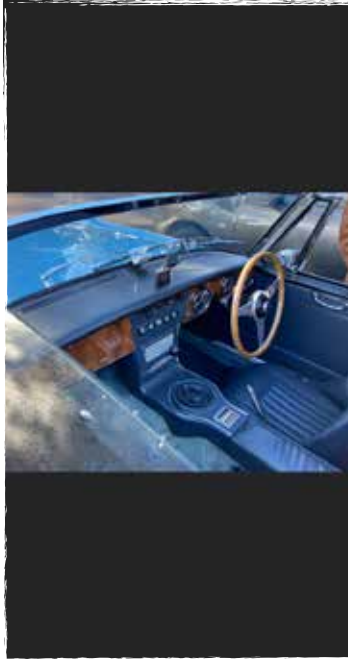
TEL	FAX	MOB
02 9439 9552	02 9438 5671	0418 964 774



Contact: Vince Cessario AHOC Member

info@platinumsplash.com.au
13 Waltham Street - Artarmon NSW 2054

MAR
18



SAT NIGHT FISH & CHIPS

**6.30 to 8.30 pm
PARADISE CAFE, LOWER
PORTLAND
Meet at McGraths Hill
Maccas 5pm dep 6pm.
Contact Denis Kasza for
details on 0407492008**

Fifty Years, Five Decades, Half a Century

By Patrick Quinn

I started writing this in April last year and originally thought to include my 50 years of AHOC membership until it occurred to me (and others) that most readers would start to nod off, not long after the first year or. Eventually thought the first five years would be sufficient which hopefully will prevent the ZZZs from taking over. One of the things that did strike me is the number of friends who are no longer with us.

I can't recall that I had any expectation of what a car club meeting was all about. Perhaps it was going to be like Mr Bean's Christmas gathering where everyone sat in a circle. I walked in and saw chairs lined up like a classroom and up front on a rostrum were two blokes sitting behind a table facing the room full of empty chairs, and there were people milling around the room. I wondered what it was all about.

It was the 19th April 1972, the third Wednesday of the month and the location was the BMC theatrette, part of the factory in the Sydney suburb of Zetland. I lived just ten minutes away at Kensington, hardly far enough for the engine of my newly acquired 100 to fully warm up.

The blokes sitting behind the desk were Ben Sellers and Alan Jones. I soon found out that Ben was the president while Alan was secretary, and it didn't take long for them to become friends. Sadly both are no longer with us and I miss them.

Apart from that, I don't remember anything about that first meeting, but our cancelled April 2022 meeting would have marked 50 years since I attended my first meeting. I got up in the May 2022 meeting and made mention that 50 years had passed since my first meeting. No matter whether you say 50 years, five decades or half a century, it's a long time.

I bought my 100 from John Thompson Sports Cars, at Burwood in March 1972. There were three Austin-Healeys on the open forecourt for sale, a red BJ8 that I later found out used to belong to Colin Rule and is now in WA, and at \$3,000 was past my budget. The other two were 100s, a blue over white car for \$1,000 and the other was finished in maroon

for \$1,295. I settled on the maroon car while the other 100 was eventually bought by Jim and Maree Gray who had a tyre business in the Sydney suburb of Gordon. Both Jim and Maree would go on to be prominent members, as did their son Chris who bought and sold a number of cars, one of them being the 100 now owned by Geoff and Carol Golding. Chris was very competition minded and was our



Competition Secretary for many years.

The 1972 AGM was held in July and I put my hand up to become assistant social secretary. Sounds important, but as there were virtually fortnightly events to be organised, I was busy. Total club membership stayed around 120 to 140, as the mass importation of cars from overseas had yet to occur. The majority of members owned 100s and while there were a few 100/6s, a 3000 was a rare beast. Events at the time revolved around breakfast and lunch runs, picnics, lap dashes followed by a BBQ at the home of a member with one of the most popular and entertaining social events like progressive dinners. This entailed starting with entrees in the late afternoon at one home, driving to another home for the main course and then on to a third home for dessert and socialising. All good fun.

Club meetings back then were enjoyable with BMC/Leyland being very hospitable with complementary coffee or tea along with a film and they even supplied a projectionist. The journeys home afterwards were also enjoyable. Many times a few of us would team up and my ten minute trip home to Kensington would be via the Cahill Expressway and the tight lefthanded tunnel leading to Sydney Harbour Bridge and take about an hour.

Mechanical Trouble

I would like to say that there wasn't any mechanical trouble with the 100, but that would be stretching the truth. I used to visit the Watsons Bay Hotel and on the Friday after I bought the car set off in the Hotel's direction. I recall turning right on to a rather busy Alison Road and changed into second only to find that there was no power getting to the rear wheels. Looking over my right shoulder there was the driver's side rear wheel sticking out from the car, but with the axle still attached.

With the limited supply of tools I had at the time, I managed to get it all back together while avoiding being skittled by a 343 bus to Randwick. Then followed a series of broken studs in both of the rear bearing carriers. The need for replacement bearing carriers had initially drawn me to the AHOC, firstly to Glyn Lambert (also sadly no longer with us), who was the Area Captain for Sydney's Eastern suburbs and then to active member Wally Gates who had previously raced a number of 100s. Yes Wally had a bearing carrier and armed with a growing supply of tools received on my 21st birthday, the car was away again. It did happen a few times after that until new studs and nuts were located.



Looking so very cool. Glyn Lambert hiding behind the boot lid

I had heard from Alan Jones of clubs in other states and leading up to Christmas 1972 I thought it would be good to visit them. It was in the days before Historic racing and Alan had entered a race meeting at Hume Weir, near Albury in his 3000 Mk1. It was easy to convince my friend Doug Treloar who had recently bought a Mk2 Roadster and become an AHOC member that he needed to join in the journey. Like so many, Doug is no longer with us.

We headed to Melbourne and arrived at the front door of Steve and Helen Pike who didn't mind having to entertain two blokes from Sydney. Also met Ed Jensz who impressed me that he knew how to disassemble and repair the ailing starter motor in the 100.



One of the many times Doug and I push started the 100.

A couple of days later we all headed north to Albury and Hume Weir to watch Alan in the races. I remember the drive for one aspect in that we decided to see how many miles to the gallon we could get. Both Steve and Doug were in the high teens with their 3000s and I won with 32mpg from the 100 engine.



Thank heavens I no longer have the cap.

50 cont'

Alan didn't win, and managed to survive a big lose on the long and left curving back part of the circuit due to a deflating tyre. From then he was known as Alan 'Spinner' Jones.

Turned Left

After Hume Weir, while everyone headed to either Melbourne or Sydney, I turned left towards Adelaide to see who I could meet there. That turned out to be John and Jenny Read who are both still very active in the South Australian AHOC. I also met with and stayed with John Veale and met Bronwyn Rose, who was to become Bronwyn Veale.

After a few days it was time to point the car eastward and head from home. Well, that was the plan and coming into the SA town of Berri I heard a tapping noise coming from the engine, plus the oil pressure wasn't looking too good. Managed to pull into a rather isolated garage where the resident mechanic/owner/cook/attendant diagnosed a run big-end bearing.

The next day, after spending the night in the 100 we headed into Renmark where there was a BMC dealer complete with a spare parts section. While he didn't have any bearings for an Austin-Healey 100 he did have spare parts manuals for both the 100 and 100/6. As they were closing a few months later he offered them to me, and I paid a small amount for them. He also told us about a local wrecker, where we found an Austin A70 which we relieved of its bearings and a single conrod.

Bearings and conrod fitted, I was soon on my way, but only got as far as Mildura when the dreaded tapping noise returned. It was into a local garage only to be told that the crankshaft was irreparable. Luckily my brother worked in the transport industry, and he arranged for the 100 to be brought back to Sydney on board a semi carrying fruit.

Soon found out that getting from Mildura to Sydney without a car wasn't quite straightforward. It was a train to Melbourne, followed by another train to Sydney. I eventually got home, and the car arrived a few days later.

Rebuild

So the engine had to come out and rebuilt, but for a reason that I can't remember it didn't happen straightaway. However, there were a few club events coming up that I was keen on attending in the Austin-Healey.

Up popped 100/6 owner John Watson who said that his father had an Austin A70 and I could borrow its engine. Sounded great, but it was still in the car which hadn't run for many years. So with the knowledge of youth, we removed the A70's engine and transported it from Hornsby to Kensington and transplanted it into the 100. After a time, we got it going and it went well despite not even changing the very old and jet-black oil.

The first run in the 100 Hereford wasn't quite as expected as when the engine was swapped in, so was the A70 flywheel and clutch. Managed to get halfway across Sydney towards Wallacia when the engine and gearbox started freewheeling resulting in the car not proceeding. I was towed back to Barry and Karyn Birch's home behind Ben Sellers' Morris Major. Following work one night during the week, I swapped the flywheel and clutch from behind the 100 engine. Worked well and the following weekend we ran in a hillclimb at Forty Bends close to Lithgow. Interesting with the A70 engine, as not only was there a lot less power, but it would valve bounce at any showing of enthusiastic driving.



Running the A70 Hereford powered 100 at Forty Bends Lithgow. The door was about to act as an air brake.

Cont next page

**50 cont'**

Complete with the A70 engine I managed to attend the 1973 Melbourne National Rally. Running with the 2.2 litre engine was interesting as while it easily ran at the speed limit, it did take a little time to get there.

Once back from the Rally, it was time to do something about the 100's engine. Thankfully I had found someone to rebuild the engine by the name of Waggott Engineering. I don't recall how I managed that, but Waggotts were renowned to be THE performance engineers in Sydney and possibly Australia. The '50s saw them building twin-camshaft cylinder heads for Holden Grey Motors and it wasn't long before they were building their own Formula Two racing engines. Why they took on an Austin-Healey 100 engine remains a mystery. I don't think they needed the \$800.00 it eventually cost me to rebuild the engine.

Thanks to Doug Treloar and his Mk2 Roadster, less its passenger seat, the engine was delivered to Waggotts. A couple of weeks later I had it back complete with new pistons and completely balanced. In the interim, thanks to Wally Gates, Waggotts was supplied with three cylinder heads and two crankshafts. They were asked to pick the best, which they did. Interesting that the head was one Wally had converted to run its cooling out through holes in its side. Ray Roberts kindly purloined some two-pack epoxy putty from some mysterious place, and we managed to plug up the holes and used the normal outlet.

The A70 engine? With the assistance of John Watson it finally came out and he took it back to his father still with the same black oil.

Steam Clean

I recall getting up at a club meeting in July 1973, announcing that the following Saturday I was hiring a steam cleaner to take care of the 100's empty engine bay. I had not met the bloke who turned up in his 100. His name was John Sherman and he keeps a journal so was able to tell me that it was 21 July 1973. I am pleased to say that we have been friends since.

A week or so later Don Read arrived in his pale yellow Holden One-Tonner complete with spray

compressor strapped on the back and he painted the engine bay a nice shade of Jaguar XJ6 maroon, which was close enough to the outside of the car.

The rebuilt engine was duly fitted with its gearbox along with all the other engine bay detritus. A few days later it was a runner. Probably a month or so later Don arrived again with two 100 chassis that he had rescued from being taken to the tip. They were 'stored' behind my mother's coal bin for a year or two, before someone had a need for them. They had chassis plates, but it was too early in the piece to realise that chassis numbers were important. Haven't got a clue what happened to them.

With its freshly painted engine and freshly painted engine bay, the 100 did look good. The AHOC concours was coming up and to be held at Vacluse House. I spent hours cleaning and polishing. I still have the trophy from winning the 100 class, but I don't think the competition was strong. Funny thing is that the car won again in 1974. Certainly odd!

The early to the mid-1970s was a time when our club was extremely enthusiastic when it came to club level Motorsport. For instance I remember one lap dash at Oran Park where there were 19 Austin-Healeys entered. The AHOC was very active in the Combined Sports Car Association with events at Silverdale hillclimb, Amaroo Park dirt circuit, hillclimb and main circuit and the well-used gymkhana circuit at the Leppington Boys Home. We were particularly tied to Silverdale and to lessen the hiring costs, club members would visit in the weeks preceding an event to carry out working bees and making sure the place was at its best.

Relay Races

In mid-1973 Alan Jones got wind of the inaugural Triumph Sports Owners Club six-hour relay race to be held at Calder in September and using contacts the AHOC received an invitation to take part.

Our club was highly enthusiastic about the event and we put together a team of five cars, namely Alan Jones (3000 Mk1 - still in Sydney), Peter Hopwood (3000 Mk3 - still in Sydney), Wally Gates (3000 Mk3 - now owned by Chris Dimmock), Chris Gray (100 - now owned by Geoff Golding) and myself



50 Cont'

(100 – in the UK). First hurdle was the lack of CAMS racing licences and Peter Hopwood and I went to our observed practice at Oran Park. Peter went on to be a well-known in motor racing circles including the All Healey race at Bathurst in 1998. Sadly, he too is no longer with us.

Ben Sellers was the team manager and he arranged practice sessions for the whole team at Oran Park. Ben also was chief mechanic and in his hands the 100 was going as quick as it ever went. The entry fees to the event were heavily subsidised by the AHOC as was the signage for each car.

The weekend arrived and to show the enthusiasm within the club, 36 members travelled south to support the team. In a past issue of Flat Chat I have written about the trip to Calder with club member Kevin Gardner with his girlfriend Christine Lyttle. Kevin was driving his father's Chrysler Valiant and towing a trailer with the 100.

In a much-shortened version, we managed to side-swipe a Toyota Crown heading in the opposite direction meaning that the 100 had to be driven the last 100 miles or so to Calder. The return journey with a three-wheel trailer was not without problems like a flat tyre.

The relay race? A huge amount of fun and everyone had mechanical problems except for Wally in the BJ8, although there was talk that he had difficulties with his radio. The BN1 gearbox in the 100 was down to two gears, after second gear stripped a couple of teeth.

Our placing after six hours? Well, we came absolutely last, but certainly at the pointy end if you consider the amount of fun we had. We even enjoyed when on removing the signage from the cars the paint on the 100 came with them. Don Read later fixed that for me.

Sitting up Front

At the AGM a few months earlier, I put my hand up to be secretary, so at meetings I got to sit up the front, next to Ben Sellers who remained president. It was during the time when the secretary also looked after membership and whatever else came along.

The October 1973 meeting was particularly memorable as when I noticed John Watson arriving through the door of the room he was with a friend by the name of Iain Walker and with them was an attractive young lady whose name was Caroline Seaver, who I would marry 27 months later. Iain would go on to buy a 100 and be an AHOC member for some years. Sadly, he is no longer with us.

The '70s saw the start of the inaugural Queensland/ NSW interstate rallies at Coffs Harbour. In '73 it was in January and I went with Ian Russell in his metallic lime green 100. It was a quick trip, but we slowed down a little when I nodded off and Ian did as well. Luckily we were quickly awakened by crossing the road and running up an embankment. The destination was always the Midway Motel and it was perfect for a group of unmarried sports car owners. I came back with John Watson and with Ian Russell was Fran Peacock in the passenger seat. They were married in just over a year. Sadly Ian is another who is no longer with us.

The following year was memorable, not only for the weekend, but because it RAINED. In fact, it rained so much that at some parts of the journey inside the 100 was awash. It was this journey that convinced John Sherman to change his 100 for a convertible. There was one run up the mountain towards Dorriggo when we stopped next to a spectacular waterfall. Ready with a packed lunch courtesy of the motel, we spread out our struggle rugs until someone screamed. What was quite lovely spot was infested with leeches. Back to the coast.

It's a Date

It was a club run to Wisemans Ferry in early 1974 and the perfect opportunity to ask Caroline Seaver if she wanted to join in the fun. We had met again at a party in the house shared by John Watson, Iain Walker and Ian Thompson, who was also an AHOC member with a 100. Ian now lives in WA and is a member of the AHC of WA.

Unfortunately, the 100's gearbox had not been repaired, so Caroline suggested that we could go in her mother's MG Midget. All went well, except the Midget's clutch thrust decided to break up, leaving the car clutch-less. We got home at the end of tow-

50 Cont'

rope behind Brian Jones' 3000 Mk1. I wasn't very popular with my future mother-in-law.

Brian had bought the 3000 from his brother Alan who had located a Chev Corvette powered 100S in St Louis, Illinois.

The year progressed and it wasn't long before Caroline and I had progressed from occasionally dating, to a permanent fixture at AHOC events.

Coinciding at this time, I heard of an interesting Austin-Healey for sale in London. The news came from Alan Jones, who had heard of it from Austin-Healey stalwart Joe Jarick via fellow Austin-Healey owners Barry Darley. Joe along with Glyn Lambert were living in London and finding and selling-on Austin-Healeys to enthusiasts in Australia. Remember this was the mid-1970s and many years before the



The BN3 after arrival in Australia, being picked up at Darling Harbour when it was a working port. BN1 behind.



The Quinn Austin-Healey at Leppington for a motorkhana The World



The Quinn Austin-Healey was purchased on these two fuzzy Polaroid photos.



formation of such entities as The Healey Factory. It was a 100 fitted with an early six-cylinder engine with the model number of 100 BN3/1. A Donald Healey Motor Company experimental vehicle that never saw the inside of a BMC factory. It was also the first 2+2 Austin-Healey built. It appealed to me and with finance provided by a fellow Austin-Healey owner who worked in the finance industry I bought it. That was in March 1974, and it arrived in Sydney during August 1974. We still have it.

Austin-Healey people throughout the world have always been of interest, and from my early ownership days I started writing to fellow owners throughout the world. Of course in those pre-email days you had to be patient.

I thought that 1975 would be a good year to visit some owners and suggested to Alan Jones that we could very well make a nuisance of ourselves overseas. So from April to October 1975, Alan Jones and I stayed with fellow Austin-Healey owners in Canada, the US, England, France and Sweden. While in the US we stayed with the previous owner of Alan's 100S and also met its first owner. The idea of staying with fellow Austin-Healey owners while travelling had not been considered beforehand, but over the next few years it became very popular, and open and welcome doors soon became known as the 'Healey Hilton'. It's a practice that continues through to the present day.

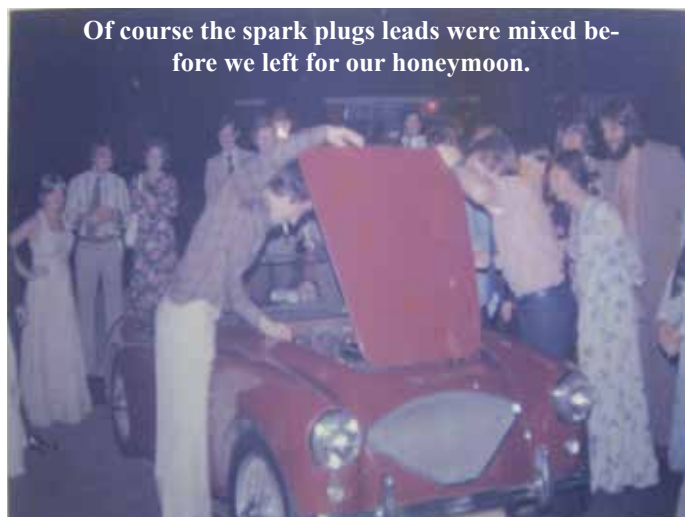
50th Cont'

While in Canada, staying with Ken Barrow, president of the Calgary Austin-Healey Club, I called and proposed to Caroline. She of course immediately accepted and after Alan and I arrived in the UK, Caroline would fly out to meet me. Ken is also no longer with us.

In the UK, while we didn't have an Austin-Healey, I did use a Jaguar Mk2 for some time until Alan and I bought the ubiquitous VW Kombi. Interesting car that took us to Austin-Healey events and people all over England and Europe. Its six-volt electrics were a bit of a challenge, as if you had the wipers running and tried to use the indicators, the engine would stall. We later sold it outside Australia House for £200.

Back Home

Back home in Australia we set the date for 17 January 1976 with the invitation list containing many AHOC members including, Ray and Muriel Roberts, Ian and Fran Russell, John and Jenny Watson, Steve and Helen Pike, Don and Anne Read, Brian Jones, Doug Treloar, Kevin Gardner and Christine Lytle (who also made the wedding cake) and Alan Jones (who was groomsman). Of course, we went on our honeymoon in the 100.



Of course the spark plugs leads were mixed before we left for our honeymoon.

In mid-1976 I heard that club member Keith Bagnall (both Carmel and Keith Bagnall are sadly gone) had found a dilapidated Healey Duncan in Sydney and dragged it home to keep his Healey Westland, 100 and 100/6 company. Alan and I went to have a look at it, and I asked for first refusal. Keith agreed and 11 years later Caroline and I bought it. The car is now under restoration in Victoria.



April 1976 when we were living at Kensington. Photo taken by NZ visitor Craig Swift.

When Alan and I were in the US, and especially California we spoke at length to local Austin-Healey people about the idea of inviting Donald Healey to local and nationwide events. A practice that the American clubs adopted with some enthusiasm for the whole Healey family. Also in 1976 Alan and I met with AHOC Vic enthusiast Roger Rayson to discuss the possibility of inviting Donald to Australia. Roger took the idea back to the Victorian committee, which grasped the idea with great enthusiasm resulting in DMH visiting both Victoria and NSW in January 1977.

DMH's visit to Sydney coincided with the Vintage Sports Car Club's Historic race meeting held at Amaroo Park on 29-30 January. The VSCC kindly agreed that Donald would be the guest of honour and that the meeting would include an all Healey race. Not wanting to miss out on such an event the 100 was duly entered in what surely proved to be the world's hottest weekend. Donald looked cool with his white terry towelling hat riding around the circuit in Keith Bagnall's Healey Westland. The race itself



Running in the All Healey race at Amaroo Park.

Lance Ruting Photo.

Cont' next page

50th Cont'

was a handicap event with the fastest cars starting at the rear. The 100 was near the front and a couple of laps into the race, Roger Wells flashed past in the MacHealey to take the chequered flag. Sadly AHOC member Roger Wells is another who is no longer with us.

All good things must come to an end, and while we were happily renting in the northern Sydney suburb of Normanhurst it was time for something more permanent. It was also influenced by Caroline being pregnant with Mark, the first of our four children.

Funds were needed to help with the deposit of our first house so towards the end of 1977 the 100 was advertised for sale at \$3,000 and it sold very quickly to a Melbourne buyer.

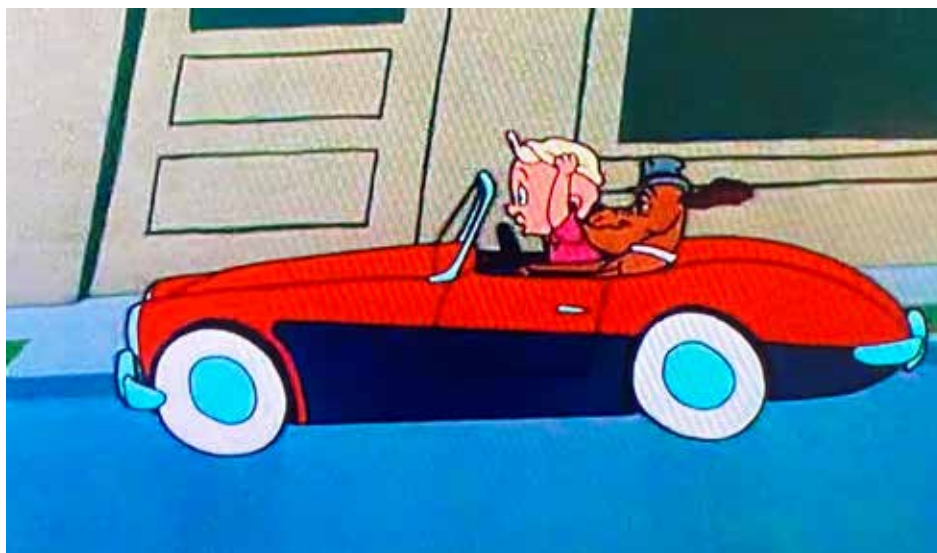
More than five years had passed since I walked into John Thompson Sports Cars at Burwood and bought the 100. We sold it to Melbourne car dealer John Ould and restored by Terry Healy. Not long after it was purchased by an US Airforce pilot who was attached to the US embassy in Canberra. When he was transferred to the UK, his family and the car went with him. It's still there.

With the 100 gone, Caroline and I had the BN3/1 which we still have. Then there was the Healey Duncan kit followed by a BN2, also in kit form that was sold. Later there were two BJ8s imported from the US, converted to RHD by Steve Pike, enjoyed and sold. Both are owned by AHOC members. Lastly came our current Healey Duncan, bought over the phone at auction in September 2013.



In addition to Mark, along came Amy in 1980, Andrew in 1989 and then in 1992 Jonathan entered this world. We are coming up to our 47th anniversary. Alan Jones went on to become Godfather to our son Mark, but tragically died as a result of a motor vehicle accident in 1979. Each of our children have Godparents who have/had Austin-Healeys and have been or are AHOC members.

I re-joined the AHOC committee in 1976 and have been a member since, holding such positions as secretary, president, registrar and editor. I was honoured to accept life membership in 2009.



Testing if you are still awake after the above.

1960 Merrie Melodies cartoon. Elmer Fudd and a dog driving what is clearly an Austin-Healey..

2022 - The Year that was through the pages of the Flat Chat Newsletter.

January

Thanks to Bryan Levy we saw how beautiful Sydney Harbour looked with an Austin-Healey 100 in the foreground.



February

Stewart Everitt hadn't long beforehand taken delivery of his new BJ8 and soon had his son Riley doing some fettling. All was not completely rosy for Tony Ash when he wondered how his 100 would perform with a tank full of diesel fuel.



March

In the March issue we read about the annual AHOC presentation lunch and Ronnie Strange questioned the workings of his 3000's rotor button.



April

The April issue showed how the club traipsed off to Retford House near Bowral for a most enjoyable day thanks to Bruce Ewan.



Cont' next page



May

There are still bargains to be found within the world of Austin-Healeys. In May we heard about the Bugeye Sprite that Terry Bancroft bought at auction from the US.



June

In June we heard about how some members went meandering to Mildura and the AHOC Vic's Mini Rally.

July

Throughout the year AHOC workshops proved to be popular and went from strength to strength. July showed the Central Coast lead by Colin and Kerrie Rule did something completely different and headed to Spencer for a coffee morning.



August

Woo Hoo! After Covid conspired against us, we were finally able to gather together for the Donald Healey Birthday Display Day. The month also saw a report on the inaugural gathering of the AHOC Central-West Chapter.



September

We were pleased to report that the inaugural Make-A-Wish Central Sydney Car Show was a resounding success. Organised by Emma Levy and her father Bryan Levy it raised over \$22K for the charity. Colin and Kerrie Rule were also pleased at the success of their latest Central Coast Workshop. We were all enthralled by a selection of Ronnie Strange paintings, with each one of course containing an Austin-Healey.

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October

Fagan Park Picnic Run – a lovely day was had by all thanks to Russell and Carol Kelly. In the hands of the Townshend brothers and Chris Komor Austin-Healeys featured at the Baskerville Historics.



December

Charlie's Run aka Purple Haze was reported in full within the December issue as was the final gathering of the Central Coast workshop at the new home of Julie and Garry Lee.



November

While low in numbers, the run to Highfield Gardens at Little Hartley was full of quality. We also heard about another Tassie Tour organised (the last) by Terry and Patricia Bancroft.



Your Last Page



The Austin stand at the 1954 Earls Court Commercial and Transport Show.

Sometimes we forget that Austin was a large manufacturer of commercial vehicles.



Wonder where the prize cars are today.



Thankfully it was a passing phase.

Is it large enough to handle a J40?



Monthly Meetings

We meet on the first Thursday of the month (not January) at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm